



CHARTING NEW WATERS: HOW ADANI PORTS ARE POWERING INDIA'S TRADE AMBITIONS

As geopolitical shifts reshape global commerce, the nation's vast port network—led by APSEZ—is emerging as the strategic bridge between the East and the West.

As global maritime trade undergoes seismic shifts, India—backed by 7,500 kilometres of uninterrupted coastline—is stepping up as a strategic connector between continents. A pivotal move is the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC), launched during the G-20 Summit in New Delhi in September 2023. Linking India with Europe via the Middle East, IMEC is seen as a counterbalance to China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) and aims to enhance rail, road, and maritime connectivity across the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Jordan, Israel, and farther afield to Europe. Launched in 2013, the BRI has an estimated total investment of over \$1 trillion and over 150 countries have signed cooperation agreements under Beijing's watch.

In this transformation, India's ports are becoming critical nodes in emerging trade corridors, driving regional partnerships and economic diversification.

India is doubling down on its port infrastructure as the global economy enters a new phase of regionalisation and

supply chain recalibration—positioning itself as a maritime powerhouse capable of connecting continents and catalysing economic growth.

With over 200 notified ports, India is naturally endowed to lead in maritime trade. But what's transforming potential into performance is a focused and forward-looking investment strategy by both the government and private sectors. The aim is clear: to build world-class port infrastructure that matches the country's expanding global trade ambitions.

Under the Sagarmala programme, the government has envisioned over ₹6 lakh crore in investments across port modernisation, connectivity, and logistics efficiency. More than 800 projects have been identified, with major ports like Mumbai, Vizag, Chennai, Paradip, and Kandla being upgraded to handle greater volumes, ensure faster turnaround times, and host larger vessels.

In parallel, strategic greenfield developments are underway—most notably the Vizhinjam International Deepwater Seaport in Kerala



"Today, at Vizhinjam, history, destiny, and possibility came together as a 30-year-old dream of Kerala became India's gateway to the world... Together, we sail towards a stronger, bolder India."

GAUTAM ADANI

Chairman, Adani Group, at the inauguration of Vizhinjam International Deepwater Multipurpose Seaport, 2 May 2025

and the Vadhavan Port in Maharashtra. These new-generation ports are designed to handle ultra-large container vessels (ULCVs), reducing reliance on transshipment hubs like Colombo and Singapore and making India a hub.

Private players like Adani Ports and Special